



GUIDE 2: VISA & RESIDENCE PERMIT

(Non-EU/EEA only)

Congratulations! You have been accepted to Fontys. For you as a student from outside the EU/EEA, the next step is the most crucial: arranging your Residence Permit for study in the Netherlands. Without this document, you cannot start your studies.

Important: Fontys arranges the application for you through the Immigration and Naturalisation Service (IND). This is called the 'accelerated procedure'. You must NEVER submit an application to the IND independently.

Timeline:

Start immediately after receiving your acceptance letter! This process officially takes 6-8 weeks, but can extend up to 12 weeks or longer.

Difficulty level:

Difficult - High costs and very strict deadlines!



STEP 1: COLLECT AND SUBMIT DOCUMENTS FOR THE VISA PROCEDURE

After receiving your Letter of Acceptance, the Fontys International Office will send you an email with a detailed list of the documents required for the visa application.

What documents do you need?

These are the most common documents. Fontys will send you the exact, current list.

Document	Description	Importance
Complete Passport Copy	All pages, including blank pages and stamps. The passport must be valid for at least 6 more months after the planned study start date.	Extremely Important! An incomplete copy will delay the procedure.
Antecedents Certificate	An official form in which you declare that you have not committed any criminal offenses. Fontys will send you the correct form.	Must be completed truthfully and signed.
Tuberculosis (TB) Examination Statement	A form in which you declare your willingness to undergo a TB test upon arrival in the Netherlands.	You do not need to take the test yet.
Proof of Financial Means	The proof that you can cover the costs of your stay and study in	Essential! The IND will not start the

Document	Description	Importance
	the Netherlands. See STEP 2 for details.	procedure without this proof.

Submitting the Documents

- **Follow Fontys's Instructions:** You will receive an email from the International Office with a unique link or an address for uploading/submitting these documents.
- **Upload/Submit Everything at Once:** Ensure all required documents are complete and of high quality.
- **Adhere to Deadlines:** Strict deadlines (usually June 1st for a September start) apply to complete the IND procedure on time before the start of the semester.

Note:

If you have a 'conditional acceptance' (e.g., you still need to obtain your diploma), you must first meet those conditions and upload your final diploma before Fontys can start the MVV/VVR procedure.

STEP 2: PAY THE 'FINANCIAL PROOF' DEPOSIT

The IND requires all Non-EU/EEA students to provide financial proof that you can cover the costs of the first 12 months of your stay in the Netherlands. Fontys usually manages this through a deposit that you transfer to them.

What do I need to pay?

The total amount you must transfer to Fontys consists of three parts:

1. **Institutional Tuition Fee:** The tuition fee for the first academic year (€12,480 for most programs, but check this).
2. **Living Costs Deposit:** A fixed amount determined by the IND to prove you can support yourself (an amount of approximately €1,000 per month).
3. **Visa Application Fee (IND Fee):** The costs charged by the IND for processing your application (approximately €228).

Total Amount: Tuition Fee + Living Costs + IND Fee = Total Amount to be transferred to Fontys

The Procedure

1. **Wait for the Official Email:** Fontys will send you an invoice with the exact total amount and the payment deadline.
2. **Pay on Time:** Transfer the full amount in one go to the Fontys bank account. Use the reference provided by Fontys.
3. **Wait for Confirmation:** Fontys will send you proof of payment. Fontys uses this proof to demonstrate to the IND that you are financially self-sufficient.

What happens to the Living Costs Deposit?

After you arrive in the Netherlands and register, Fontys will refund this amount in monthly installments to your new, Dutch bank account. This essentially serves as your living allowance for the first months.

STEP 3: IND PROCEDURE & DECISION

Upon receipt of all documents and payment, Fontys submits a combined application to the IND for:

- **MVV (Provisional Residence Permit):** This is the entry visa that allows you to travel to the Netherlands (required for certain nationalities).
- **VVR (Regular Residence Permit):** This is the final residence permit for study purposes.

Important: Fontys automatically determines if you need an MVV based on your nationality and includes that application in the procedure.

The Decision

Positive Decision:

You will receive an email from Fontys stating that the IND has approved your application. Congratulations!

Instructions for MVV Collection (if required):

- You will receive instructions to schedule an appointment at the Dutch Embassy or Consulate in your country or region.
- You must go to the Embassy with your passport to have the MVV sticker placed inside it.
- From the moment the MVV is in your passport, you have 3 months to travel to the Netherlands.

Travelling to the Netherlands (VVR):

- If you do not require an MVV, you may travel to the Netherlands immediately after the positive decision.
- Bring the positive IND decision with you in your hand luggage.

STEP 4: AFTER ARRIVAL IN THE NETHERLANDS

You have landed safely! The MVV/VVR procedure is not yet fully complete.



1. The TB Examination (if required)

- Students from certain countries (consult the IND website) must undergo a Tuberculosis (TB) examination within 3 months of arrival.
- Fontys will send you instructions on where and when to get this free examination.

2. Appointment for the Residence Permit (VVR)

- Fontys will schedule an appointment for you at an IND desk (e.g., in Eindhoven or Den Bosch) to pick up your residence card.
- You must attend in person. Bring your passport and any other required documents.
- The VVR (a card, similar to an ID) is your official residence permit for the duration of your study (maximum 5 years).
- Once you have this card, you are fully and legally registered as a student in the Netherlands.

CHECKLIST: Visa & Residence Permit (VVR)

- ☐ All visa application documents (passport, statements) have been submitted to Fontys.

- ☐ The full 'Financial Proof' (Tuition Fee + Living Costs + IND Fee) has been paid to Fontys.
- ☐ The positive decision from the IND has been received.
- ☐ The MVV (if needed) has been collected from the Embassy.
- ☐ You have arrived in the Netherlands.
- ☐ The appointment for collecting the VVR card has been attended.
- ☐ Your VVR residence card is in your possession.

IMPORTANT LINKS

Topic	Link
Fontys International Office	international@fontys.nl
Fontys Visa/MVV/VVR Information	fontys.nl/en/Study-at-Fontys/.../Visa-residence-permit.htm 
IND (Provisional Residence Permit - MVV)	ind.nl/en/provisional-residence-permit-mvv 
IND (Student Residence Permit - VVR)	ind.nl/en/residence-permits/study/student-residence-permit... 
Fontys Financial Requirements & Deposit	Check the most recent email from Fontys for the exact amount and payment link.

YOU DID IT!

Congratulations! The biggest administrative hurdle has been cleared.

What is the next step?

Finding accommodation in the Netherlands is the biggest challenge for international students. You must start this NOW if you haven't already.

→ [Continue to Guide 3: Housing](#)

Timeline reminder:

- Guide 3 (Housing): Start NOW - can take 6+ months!
- Guide 4 (Health Insurance): 1-2 months before arrival
- Guide 5 (Register in NL): Within the first 5 days after arrival

Good luck with your start! You are one step closer to your dream.

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